Sanket Edge — User Guide

Raspberry Pi listening station for police and emergency control rooms

Sanket Edge turns a Raspberry Pi and a speaker into an always-on listener. It plays every Sanket PTT transmission, transcribes it on the Pi, reads it aloud, and raises alerts. It is **receive-only** unless you turn on forwarding for a local mic.

1. One-touch install

1. Use a Raspberry Pi 5 (recommended) or Pi 3 with Raspberry Pi OS (Desktop or Lite), connected to the internet and a speaker.
2. Open a terminal on the Pi and run:

   ```
   curl -fsSL https://vibhvesh.github.io/sanketptt/pi/install.sh | bash
   ```

3. Wait for it to finish. It prints the web page address.
4. Run the same command any time to **upgrade**. Settings, recordings and voices are kept.

Options: add `SANKET_KIOSK=0` to skip the full-screen display, `SANKET_KIOSK=1` to force it, or `SANKET_HW=pi3|pi5` to choose the board profile, e.g. `curl -fsSL …/install.sh | SANKET_KIOSK=0 bash`.

2. Dashboard and kiosk

1. On any phone or PC on the same network, open **http://<pi-name>.local:8080** (or **http://<pi-ip>:8080**).
2. **Home** shows system health (CPU, temperature, RAM, disk, network), message graphs, input levels and the latest messages.
3. **Live** shows the message feed with transcripts, alerts, SSTV pictures and playback.
4. With a display attached, the Pi logs in on boot and opens the dashboard **full screen** (kiosk). If the browser closes, it reopens.



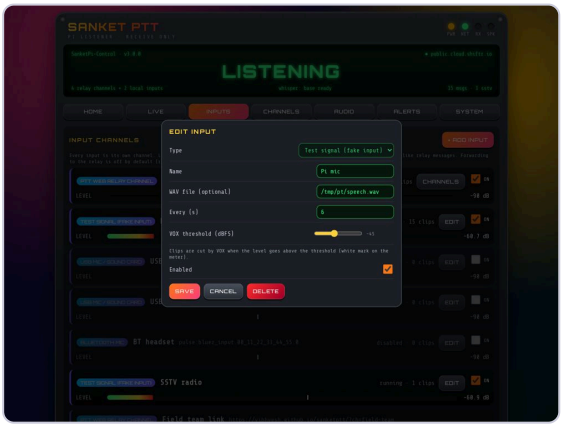


3. Inputs

Every input is a channel, listed on the **Inputs** tab.

1. **Relay:** a Sanket PTT channel link (`…/?ch=name`). Add more with **+ Add input**.
2. **Pi mic**, **USB mics / sound cards** (one channel each) and **Bluetooth mics**.
3. Local inputs use **VOX**: set threshold, hang time and gain with **Edit**. Watch the level meter while someone speaks.
4. Forwarding a local input to the relay is **off** by default.





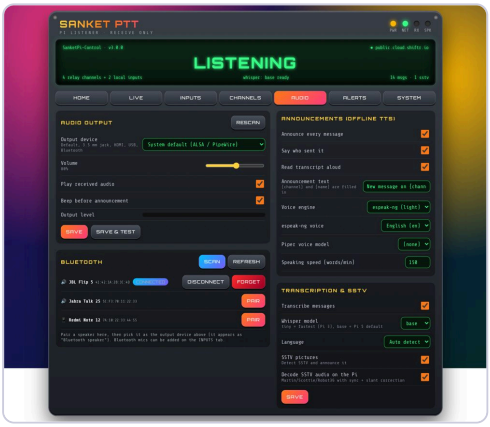
3a. RTL-SDR receiver

Plug an RTL2832U/R820T USB dongle into the Pi and add an **RTL-SDR receiver** input (Inputs → + Add input). It runs `rtl_fm` and feeds the audio through the same VOX → recording → offline transcription → announcement → dashboard path as the mic inputs. Works on Pi 3 and Pi 5.

- **Settings per input:** frequency (MHz), mode (NFM, FM, WBFM, AM), squelch (0 = off), tuner gain (`auto` or dB), sample rate, PPM correction, dongle index. You can also give a comma-separated **scan list** and a **dwell time**. The receiver stays on a frequency while a transmission is in progress.
- **Presets:** FM broadcast 88-108 (WBFM), airband 118-137 (AM), 2 m ham 144-146 (NFM), 70 cm ham 430-440 (NFM), marine VHF 156-162 (NFM).
- **Detect dongle** runs `rtl_test` and shows what it finds. The level meter shows the received audio level.
- The installer adds the `rtl-sdr` package, blacklists the `dvb_usb_rtl28xxu` TV driver and adds a udev rule. Unplug and replug the dongle (or reboot) after the first install.
- **Legal:** this is receive only. Listen only to public bands or bands you are licensed to listen to (broadcast, airband, amateur, marine). Do not monitor police, government or private communications. That is restricted under the Indian Wireless Telegraphy Act.

4. Audio output and Bluetooth

1. Open **Audio** and choose the output: default, 3.5 mm jack, HDMI, USB or Bluetooth speaker.
2. Set the **volume** and press **Play & test**.
3. For Bluetooth: put the speaker in pairing mode, tap **Scan**, then **Pair** and **Connect**. Use **Disconnect** or **Forget** to remove it.

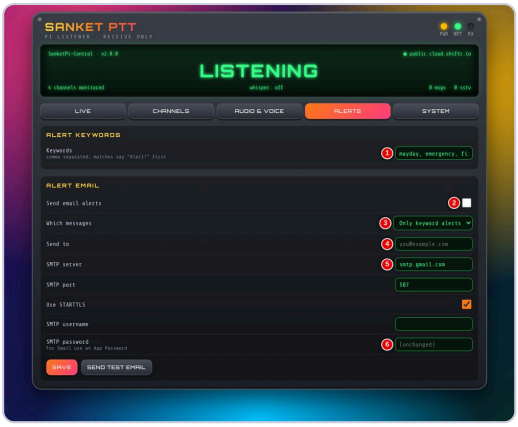


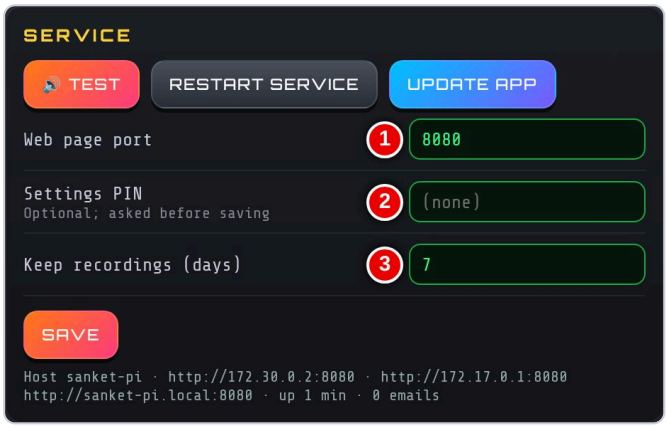
5. Announcements and transcription

1. Each message is played, then announced: *"New message on <channel> from <name>"*, then the transcript is read out.
2. On **Audio**, turn announcements on or off, edit the text and choose the voice (Piper or espeak-ng) and speed.
3. Transcription runs offline (Whisper). Choose the model and language, or **Auto detect**.

6. Alerts and PIN

1. On **Alerts**, enter keywords (e.g. mayday, emergency). A match is announced with *"Alert! Alert!"* first.
2. Optionally turn on alert email, fill in the SMTP details and press **Send test email**.
3. On **System**, set a **Settings PIN** right after installing. Anyone can view the dashboard; changes need the PIN.





7. Always on

1. Starts on boot and restarts automatically if it stops.
2. A hardware watchdog reboots the Pi if it hangs.
3. Wi-Fi power-save and screen blanking are turned off; the relay reconnects on its own.

8. Pi 5 versus Pi 3

Board	Transcription	Voice	SSTV decode	Kiosk browser
Pi 5 / Pi 4	Whisper base	Piper	On	Chromium
Pi 3 / Zero 2	Whisper tiny	espeak-ng	Off	surf (Desktop) / skipped on Lite

Defaults are set once at first install; your later changes are kept.

9. Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
Page will not open	Use the IP: run `hostname -I` on the Pi, open `http://<ip>:8080`.
No sound	Check speaker power and output device on **Audio**; press **Play & test**.
Bluetooth speaker silent	**Scan** → **Pair** → **Connect** again, then select it as output.
Mic input never triggers	Lower the VOX threshold; check the level meter.
Slow transcripts on Pi 3	Keep the **tiny** model.
Check the service	`sudo systemctl status sanket-pi` · logs: `journalctl -u sanket-pi -f`
Update	**System** → **Update app**, or rerun the install command.

10. Support

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